

Feature Comparison — Hardware MIDI Sequencers (Budget Segment)

Devices Compared

- Portable MIDI Sequencer — Alpha 1
- Arturia KeyStep
- Arturia KeyStep Pro
- Korg Volca (generic sequencer use)
- Korg SQ-64

Core MIDI Sequencing Capabilities

Feature	Alpha 1	KeyStep	KeyStep Pro	Korg Volca	Korg SQ-64
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Pure MIDI sequencer	Yes	No	No	No	Partial
Live MIDI recording	Yes	Limited	Limited	Limited	Limited
Multi-track sequencing	16 tracks	1	4	1	4
16 MIDI channels	Yes	No	Partial	No	Partial
External instruments	Up to 16	No	Limited	No	Limited
Project save/load	Yes	No	No	No	Limited
Standalone (no computer)	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes

Workflow & Interaction

Feature	Alpha 1	KeyStep	KeyStep Pro	Korg Volca	Korg SQ-64
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Performance-first workflow	Yes	Partial	Partial	No	Partial
Linear recording	Yes	Partial	Partial	No	Partial
Loop recording	Yes	Partial	Partial	No	Partial
Step/grid sequencing	No	Partial	Partial	Yes	Yes
Minimal screen gazing	Yes	Yes	Partial	Partial	Partial

Connectivity & Hardware

- MIDI TRS In / Out
- 5-pin DIN via adapter
- Internal clock
- MIDI Clock In / Out — Planned
- 0.96" OLED display
- 8 LEDs for visual feedback

Price Positioning

- Alpha 1: \$100–150
- KeyStep: ~\$100
- KeyStep Pro: ~\$350

- Korg Volca: ~\$150–200
- Korg SQ-64: ~\$200–250

Key Takeaway

Alpha 1 occupies a unique position as a budget, performance-oriented, multi-track, multi-channel hardware MIDI sequencer designed for computer-free, hands-on music creation.